



MOSAICS OFTEN PORTRAYED SCENES
AND OBJECTS FROM EVERYDAY LIFE.

around the town's arena. The painting not only shows us the fight between the Pompeians and visitors from Nuceria, but it also shows the arena's seats, stairways, entrances, and canopy.

Craft of the mosaic maker

If there's one Roman craft that everyone's heard of, it's mosaic—the art of making pictures from

small cubes of colored stone, glass, or pottery. But did you know that mosaic was actually invented by the Greeks, not the Romans? It's another example of how the Romans copied other people's good ideas. However, in the hands of the Roman mosaicists (that's the name for people who make mosaics), the craft reached perfection. The mosaics were made by laying different-colored stone cubes, some just 0.2 in (5 mm) across, in wet plaster.